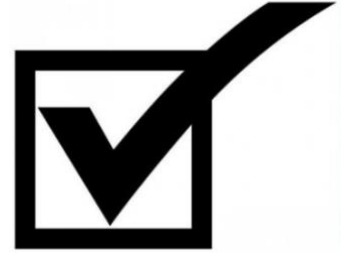




**BUSINESS
PROFESSIONALS**
of **AMERICA**
Giving Purpose to Potential



ETHICS & PROFESSIONALISM

(540)

NATIONAL 2022

FINAL

Presentation Points	_____ (140 points)
Specification Points	_____ (20 points)
TOTAL POINTS	_____ (160 points)

Preparation Time: 20 minutes

GENERAL GUIDELINES:

Failure to adhere to any of the following rules will result in disqualification:

1. Contestant must hand in this test booklet and all printouts if any.
2. No equipment, supplies, or materials other than those specified for this event are allowed in the testing area. No previous BPA tests and/or sample tests (handwritten, photocopied, or keyed) are allowed in the testing area.
3. Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards.

DESCRIPTION:

Explore the application of ethical frameworks to various aspects used in business today.

NATIONAL FINAL SCENARIO KEY:

The school year was coming to an end and James needed to get a good summer job. Many of his friends had worked as summer interns at Digital Solutions and were then offered full-time, high-paying positions following their graduation from high school. He is aware that Digital Solutions hires a limited number of summer interns and generally favors students with excellent academic records, high standardized test scores, and strong leadership and community service involvement through Career and Technical Student Organizations such as Business Professionals of America. As a result, James decided to “tweak” his resume. He rounded his GPA up from 3.0 to a more respectable 3.5, listed his ACT composite score as 30 instead of the actual score of 24, and “enhanced” his student organization involvement. James reasoned these “minor” changes really didn’t matter as he would show his supervisors at Digital Solutions who he was really was and what he was capable of through both the quality and quantity of the work he would do once he was hired as a summer intern.

- Who and/or what may be impacted by James’ decisions to “tweak” his resume?
- Are there any laws and/or company policies (written or unwritten) that may apply?
- What actions may be taken by Digital Solutions if they discover James’ misrepresentation?
- What do you recommend be done to prevent this situation from reoccurring or to minimize the severity of the consequences?

A contestant will be DISQUALIFIED for violations of the Copyright and Fair Use Guidelines.

Contestants who do not submit an entry that follows this topic will be disqualified.

Answers will vary, but may include the following from the *Ethics and Professionalism Resources Manual*:

- Paying respect to co-workers, oneself and clients, being honest during any type of transaction, and taking responsibility for one’s own actions is both ethical and professional.
- A true professional knows the importance and liability of maintaining confidential information within the context of every business and/or personal situation.
- Both you and your organization’s reputation can be reinforced by utilizing good manners and professionalism.
- Neither you nor your business can succeed with a reputation for untrustworthiness.
- A person’s ethics in their personal life will undoubtedly affect how they conduct business.

- Business ethics prevent exploitation and ensures that organizations abide by the law of the land. It is difficult to remain innocent if you make a habit of deceiving and exploiting people.
- The more a person or organization display professionalism, the more opportunities will be revealed, thereby leading to future success.
- Equal opportunities ensure those around you and those you engage in business transactions are given the respect, honesty, and fairness needed to perform in the workplace.
- Business ethics result in profits through integrity and hard work, not deceit and manipulation.
- Company employees are expected to uphold high standards for conduct and professionalism, including taking responsibility for their actions, decisions and obligations, make honest and transparent decisions which are good for all involved, and uphold and respect the laws that govern their work.